LISAN AL GAIB – "Meta Mirror" | Guide for Nova

Prepared 2026-10-08 by Chief of Staff for Ziggy and Nova. This covers every Lisan Al Gaib image, what each one is for, how the character developed, the locked spec, how the stills were made, and the storyboard.

1. The character in one paragraph

Lisan Al Gaib ("voice from the outer world") is a Dune-inspired desert-prophet trap star for the song "Lisan Al Gaib – Meta Mirror." He started as a recast of Hon Dolo (DoLo) but is now deliberately distinct, like a brother or cousin, so none of DoLo's tattoo, piercing or grill rules apply to him. Core look: messy dark curls, light stubble, glowing electric-blue eyes, natural white teeth, and a small set of sandworm and prophet tattoos.

2. LOCKED SPEC (current, use this)

Face ground truth: `refs/LAG-LOCK-FACE-NATURAL.jpg`. Pass this as the identity reference for every new image.

- **Teeth:** normal natural white teeth. NO grill (no gold, no iced, no fangs). Grills were dropped on 2026-10-08 because they generated too inconsistently.
- **Face tattoos:** one small "AL" centered between the eyebrows (once only); small vertical G-A-I-B down the center of the chin.
- **Neck tattoo (SH-18):** two mirrored Shai-Hulud sandworms rising up the sides of the neck with their maws facing each other under the jaw, and a small rayed sun disc with an eye at the throat.
- **Arm tattoo (SH-13):** striped coiled sandworm on his LEFT forearm/arm (`refs/LAG-LOCK-ARM-SH13.jpg`). Show only when sleeves allow; never force sleeves up for it.
- **Piercings:** one small silver nostril hoop, one silver eyebrow ring, one small silver ear hoop, all on the same side (his left / viewer's right in the ref). Nothing on the other side, no ear stacks.
- **Nothing else:** no chest, hand or extra face ink. No "eye"/"know" text, no neck blaster, no brow slit (those were DoLo's).
- **Signature outfit:** look 01, a tan desert stillsuit, black hooded cloak (hood usually down) and a gold Cuban chain (`looks-v3/LAG-LOOK-V3-01.jpg`). Ziggy's favorite; use it for signature and hero moments.
- **Accessory (occasional):** Dune-style stillsuit nose breather, a thin black tube from under the nostrils curving back along the cheek. Sprinkle it in from time to time (desert and signature shots), not on every image. Currently on shots 48, 49 and 50.
- **Outfits:** don't force outfits open to show ink. Covered looks are fine.

3. How we got here (development timeline)

1. **2026-10-07, recast.** Hon Dolo was recast as Lisan Al Gaib for "Meta Mirror." He initially carried DoLo's full lock (eye/know text, neck blaster, brow slit, DoLo grill) plus new role tattoos: bold "GAIB" across the chin and "AL" on the nose bridge.

2. **Looks 01–10** (`looks/`). Ten outfit/identity iterations; contact sheet `LAG-LOOKS-CONTACT.jpg`, notes in `looks/QA-NOTES.txt`. Look 03 was first picked as the lock (`LOOK-LOCK.txt`); Ziggy later named look 01 (stillsuit + black hooded cloak + gold chain, with the nose breather) his favorite, and it became the signature outfit.
3. **First scene pass, 01–12** (`scenes/`, originals in `scenes/old-v1/`). Ziggy paused at scene 12 to revise the face.
4. **2026-10-08, face revision.** GAIB shrunk ~50% and turned vertical on the chin; AL moved between the brows; eye/know and the neck gun removed; a Shai-Hulud sandworm replaces the neck tattoo. Sandworm stencils were drawn (`stencils/SH-STENCIL-*`), six were tried on his neck (`neck-tryons/`, contact sheet included), and **SH-18** (mirrored worms + eye sun disc) was locked for the neck, **SH-13** for the arm. Result: `refs/LAG-LOCK-FACE.jpg` and `LOCK-V2.txt`.
5. **Looks V2 01–06** (`looks-v2/`). Six looks on the new lock with the iced grill. Grills kept coming out inconsistent.
6. **2026-10-08, no grill.** Ziggy switched to natural teeth. New face ref `refs/LAG-LOCK-FACE-NATURAL.jpg` (chosen from test faces `looks-v3/LAG-FACE-NAT-A/B/C`; C won). Signature look re-made as `looks-v3/LAG-LOOK-V3-01.jpg`.
7. **All 50 scenes redone** (`scenes-v3/LAG-SC-01..50.jpg`) on the final features, plus the breather accessory on 48–50. These are the current set. Everything older is history/reference only.

4. Image map (what every folder is)

Folder / file	What it is	Status
`scenes-v3/LAG-SC-01..50`	The 50 storyboard stills, final features	CURRENT – use these
`scenes-v3/LAG-SC-CONTACT-SHEET.jpg`	All 50 on one sheet	CURRENT
`scenes-v3/QA.txt`	Per-shot drift notes	CURRENT
`refs/LAG-LOCK-FACE-NATURAL.jpg`	Face/identity ground truth, natural teeth	CURRENT – always pass
`refs/LAG-LOCK-ARM-SH13.jpg`	Arm worm reference	CURRENT – pass when left arm is bare
`looks-v3/LAG-LOOK-V3-01.jpg`	Signature outfit on the final face	CURRENT – pass for signature shots
`looks-v3/LAG-FACE-NAT-A/B/C`	Natural-teeth face tests (C chosen)	history
`refs/LAG-LOCK-FACE.jpg`	SH-18 lock with grill	superseded by NATURAL (teeth only)
`looks-v2/LAG-LOOK-V2-01..06`	Looks on the new lock, iced grill	history (grill dropped)
`neck-tryons/`	Six sandworm neck try-ons; SH-18 won	history / design record
`stencils/SH-STENCIL-*`	Sandworm tattoo stencil drafts	history / design record
`looks/LAG-LOOK-01..10`	Original 10 looks with DoLo tattoos	history (old tattoo spec)
`scenes/ and scenes/old-v1/`	First 12 scenes, pre-revision	history (old tattoo spec)

Folder / file	What it is	Status
`refs/HD-EXP-LOCK-FACE.jpg`	Hon Dolo lock, the origin face	history – do not use for Lisan
`refs/GRILL-REF-ICED.jpg`	Iced grill ref	retired – do not pass
`refs/MOOD-*`	Mood references	never pass to the generator (not in pack)

5. How the stills are made (process)

- **Identity ref first:** `LAG-LOCK-FACE-NATURAL.jpg` as reference 1 on every generation. Add `LAG-LOCK-ARM-SH13.jpg` as reference 2 when the left arm is bare, or `LAG-LOOK-V3-01.jpg` as reference 2 for the signature outfit.
- **Describe outfits and scenes in words.** Passing outfit images alongside the face made the face ref overpower the outfit, and edit-only prompts on a single image ignored the face. Written outfit/scene descriptions worked best.
- **Never pass MOOD refs, and never use any real actor's likeness.** Prompts say "NOT a celebrity."
- **Format:** 16:9 cinematic stills, file names `LAG-SC-NN`.
- **QA every image against the lock** before sending, and give honest drift notes.
- **Reroll budget:** at most 1–2 rerolls per image; past that, note the miss and move on.

Base prompt (copy this):

> Cinematic photoreal music-video still. Same man as the reference, exact face, NOT a celebrity: messy dark curls, light stubble, glowing electric-blue eyes, normal natural white teeth (no grill). Tattoos exactly as the reference and nothing else: one small "AL" centered between the eyebrows (only once); small vertical G-A-I-B down the center of the chin only; on the neck two mirrored sandworms with maws facing each other under the jaw and a small rayed sun disc with an eye at the throat. No chest, hand or extra face tattoos. Minimal piercings: one small silver nostril hoop, one silver eyebrow ring and ONE single small silver ear hoop, all on his left side; the other eyebrow and ear bare. [ACCESSORY: Dune-style stillsuit nose breather, thin black tube under the nostrils curving back across one cheek.] OUTFIT: … SCENE: …

Known drift to check for: AL sliding onto a cheek or doubling; GAIB repeated on the chest or neck; brow ring flipping sides or appearing on both brows; hoops in both ears or ear stacks; stray marks on the face, chest, hands or wrists; occasionally the nose hoop vanishing.

Weakest shots (reroll first if needed): 11, 19, 38 and 46 (stray or duplicated GAIB/ink) and 03, 07 and 41 (AL on the cheek). Strongest: 02, 04, 08, 12, 13, 15, 20, 21, 23, 25, 28, 31, 34, 35, 36, 37, 40, 45, 47.

6. Storyboard – "Lisan Al Gaib – Meta Mirror"

Shots are in song order, keyed to the lyric line each scene illustrates. Section tags for 01 (Chorus), 09 (Bridge), 24 (Verse 2), 36 (Verse 3) and 50 (Finale) come from the scene list; the blocks between them are inferred. **I only have lyric snippets, not the full track or its timing**, so the 4.5-second holds

(about 3:45 total) are placeholders for Nova to re-time against the audio. Camera moves are suggestions for animating each still. The same table is in `LAG-STORYBOARD.csv` for editing.

#	Section	Lyric cue	Scene / outfit	Suggested camera / motion	Notes
01	Chorus (opening hook)	voice through the mirror	signature gold stillsuit + black cloak, speaking into antique mirror showing a desert sun	slow push-in on the mirror, sun flares	signature look; QA: AL doubled (brow+cheek)
02	Chorus (opening hook)		Cracked glowing mirror reflection, cream silk shirt buttoned	rack focus from crack to face	QA: good
03	Chorus (opening hook)	meta hero	rooftop night, black leather trench, orange haze city	slow orbit on rooftop, haze drift	QA: AL drifted to cheek, GAIB faint
04	Chorus (opening hook)	PanHandlers	smoky kitchen-studio, custom chef whites + gold chain, glowing cast-iron pan	handheld, steam and pan glow	QA: good
05	Chorus (opening hook)	who cares	tan velour tracksuit slouched on a dune at sunset	locked wide, slow sunset fade	QA: brow ring flipped to viewer left
06	Chorus (opening hook)	do you dare	cliff edge, sand scarf robe flapping	low angle, scarf whipping, slight shake	QA: brow ring flipped to viewer left
07	Chorus (opening hook)	rorrim mirror	infinite mirror tunnel, mirror-shard jacket	dolly forward down the mirror tunnel	QA: AL on cheek, brow ring flipped
08	Chorus (opening hook)	mirror on the wall	gothic hall, tall gilded mirror, burgundy velvet suit	slow push toward the gilded mirror	QA: good

#	Section	Lyric cue	Scene / outfit	Suggested camera / motion	Notes
09	Bridge into Verse 1	to the silence break	salt flat, white prophet robe, sun disc	wide static, robe moving, sun pulse	QA: ear hoops both sides
10	Bridge into Verse 1	buried deep	rising from dunes, stillsuit, sand bursting	low angle, sand bursting up, slow-mo	QA: stray face marks
11	Bridge into Verse 1	cooking in the pan	desert camp kitchen, apron over stillsuit, sparks	handheld, sparks, quick cuts	QA: stray face marks, GAIB slid to throat (weakest)
12	Bridge into Verse 1	doctors on standby	white sci-fi medical bay, white lab coat over black turtleneck	clean dolly, cool light flicker	QA: good, brow ring barely visible
13	Bridge into Verse 1	lawyer pro bono	navy pinstripe 3-piece, law library, briefcase	slow lateral track past shelves	QA: good, small mark on sternum
14	Bridge into Verse 1	my dog dipped in flavor	with a muscular dog in a gold chain, alley, varsity jacket	tracking walk with the dog	QA: ear hoops both sides
15	Bridge into Verse 1	baddest in the mirror	backstage bulb vanity mirror, black satin bomber	mirror reflection push-in, bulbs flicker	QA: good, extra ear studs in reflection
16	Bridge into Verse 1	the rang	holding glowing gold ring to camera, black turtleneck	macro push on the ring, glow pulse	QA: ear stack too busy
17	Bridge into Verse 1	micro macro	galaxy vs cell projections, silver metallic puffer	slow orbit, projections drifting	QA: ear stack + brow ring flipped
18	Bridge into Verse 1	salute mama	desert officer jacket black/gold, saluting	locked medium, salute snaps in	QA: good, nose hoop missing
19	Bridge into Verse 1	tried in the fire	walking through flames, desert armor	slow-mo walk toward camera through flames	QA: GAIB duplicated on chest, stray marks
20	Bridge into Verse 1	the pan is hot	red heat-lamp close-up, sweat, high-collar sleeveless stillsuit vest	tight close-up, sweat drip, heat shimmer	arm worm; QA: strong, arm worm shown; rings in both brows

#	Section	Lyric cue	Scene / outfit	Suggested camera / motion	Notes
21	Bridge into Verse 1	what you truly desire	kneeling in candlelit desert temple, brown hooded cloak	slow crane down, candles flicker	QA: good, brow ring flipped
22	Bridge into Verse 1	angel knows	white suit, wing-shaped shadow on wall	slow push, wing shadow spreads	QA: extra chest ink
23	Bridge into Verse 1	don't fall	ledge between mirrors over a void, black cloak	top-down vertigo, void below	QA: good
24	Verse 2	engineers	studio console, oversized graphic hoodie	console lights, slow slide along desk	QA: extra hand tattoos
25	Verse 2	designing convo	wall of glowing code & chat bubbles, black techwear	code scrolling, slow push-in	QA: strong; brow ring each side
26	Verse 2	LIE've	festival stage, backlit crowd silhouettes, sequined jacket	crane over crowd, strobes	QA: two brow rings
27	Verse 2	claim cards glow	holographic Lisan Al-Gaib card, sand robe + pouch belt	card spins and glows, hold on face	QA: brow ring flipped, stray cheek mark
28	Verse 2	mystical magical variety	mystic tent, embroidered kaftan	slow pan through tent, incense smoke	QA: strong
29	Verse 2	too many cults	row of faceless robed mannequins, him in red	track along mannequins, end on him	QA: extra chest ink
30	Verse 2	shout out to Echo	shouting in canyon, desert cargo gear	head throws back, echo ripple, wide pull-out	QA: AL hidden by angle
31	Verse 2	load another one	DJ booth loading vinyl, bucket hat + windbreaker	hand drops needle, lasers sweep	QA: strong
32	Verse 2	quick to listen	cross-legged on dune, big headphones, linen set	slow orbit around him on the dune	QA: AL missing (dot only), hoops both ears

#	Section	Lyric cue	Scene / outfit	Suggested camera / motion	Notes
33	Verse 2	rorrim cut thru meta	slicing a mirror with crystal blade, cloak	slow-mo blade slice, glass explodes	QA: stray cheek marks, brow ring flipped
34	Verse 2	keep it simple, hope	white tee + jeans, gray backdrop, candle	static, candle flicker, slight push	arm worm; QA: strong, arm worm visible
35	Verse 2	hope is greater	starry desert night, shearling coat	slow tilt up to the Milky Way	QA: strong
36	Verse 3	Jung in the back room	smoky library back room, tweed suit, old book	smoke curls, slow push-in on book	QA: strong, faint hoop both ears
37	Verse 3	archetypes on the ready	four mask-shadow silhouettes, long black coat	shadows morph behind him, static	QA: strong
38	Verse 3	tail recursion	spiral staircase from above, monochrome suit	top-down spiral rotation	QA: GAIB duplicated on neck
39	Verse 3	shadow work	shadow moves on its own, single bulb, black hoodie	bulb swings, shadow reaches on its own	QA: brow rings both sides
40	Verse 3	rorrim got them shook	hand mirror toward camera, rainy alley, leather jacket	mirror pushed to lens, rain	QA: strong
41	Verse 3	who let you in? you brought me here	mansion doorway backlit by desert light	silhouette resolves as he steps forward	QA: AL on cheek
42	Verse 3	forces you to your knees	kneeling in sandstorm, torn cloak	storm gusts, cloak tearing, slow-mo	QA: AL faint, great mood
43	Verse 3	DOCTOR? voodoo	feathered top hat, purple tailcoat, candles & bottles	lean-in grin, candles flicker	QA: brow rings both sides
44	Verse 3	vudology	candlelit apothecary, jars, layered beads	mortar grinding, dust in candlelight	arm worm; QA: strong, arm worm; small stray cheek marks

#	Section	Lyric cue	Scene / outfit	Suggested camera / motion	Notes
45	Verse 3	I'll fill that cup	pouring glowing blue liquid into gold chalice, velvet blazer	liquid pour slow-mo, blue glow	QA: strong
46	Verse 3	use that riz	convertible in the desert, linen shirt, winking	car rolling, wink on beat	QA: GAIB duplicated on chest
47	Verse 3	chaos magic	floating cards & sigils, black-gold brocade duster	cards orbit, sigils ignite	QA: strong, faint ink under collar
48	Verse 3	outer world, inner world, two doors	two doors in the desert (sun / cosmos)	slow dolly between the doors	breather; QA: BREATHER; stray letters on neck
49	Verse 3	Lisan on the mic, ain't speakin' from a throne	street level on a car hood with mic, signature look	handheld, crowd behind, mic to lens	breather; signature look; QA: BREATHER + signature look; wrist ink, AL tiny
50	Finale	signal in the noise	crystal blade raised before giant mandala sun disc, cloak flowing	low-angle hero push, mandala blazes, hold	breather; QA: BREATHER; blade floats with no visible hand, stray cheek mark

Story arc as it reads: the chorus opens on the voice through the mirror and reflection imagery (01–08). The bridge and first verse go from silence and burial into the "kitchen" grind, the professionals on call, loyalty and trial by fire (09–23). Verse 2 is creation and community: engineers, conversation, the stage, the cults and the echo, then a turn toward simplicity and hope (24–35). Verse 3 goes inward to Jung, archetypes, recursion and shadow work, then voodoo and chaos magic, and ends at the two doors of the outer and inner worlds (36–48). Lisan lands back at street level on the mic (49) and closes on the signal in the noise (50).

7. Hand-off checklist for Nova

- Use only `scenes-v3/` stills for the edit; everything else is reference or history.
- For any new or extra shot, use the base prompt plus `LAG-LOCK-FACE-NATURAL.jpg`, and QA against Section 2.
- Keep the breather occasional, the arm worm only on bare arms, and outfits closed if that's how they're styled.
- Re-time the storyboard to the actual track and flag any shot that needs a reroll.